

THE USE OF TENSES: WHERE AND HOW

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VERB TENSES





TENSES OF THE VERBS

YESTERDAY

Sam played blocks.



The action is done in the past.

PAST TENSE

TODAY

The children play.



The action happens today or every day.

PRESENT TENSE

TOMORROW

She will play with her doll.



The action will be done in the future.

FUTURE TENSE

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

-S
Form

Past
Form

-ING
Form

Past
Participle
Form

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

-S
Form

eats

Past
Form

ate

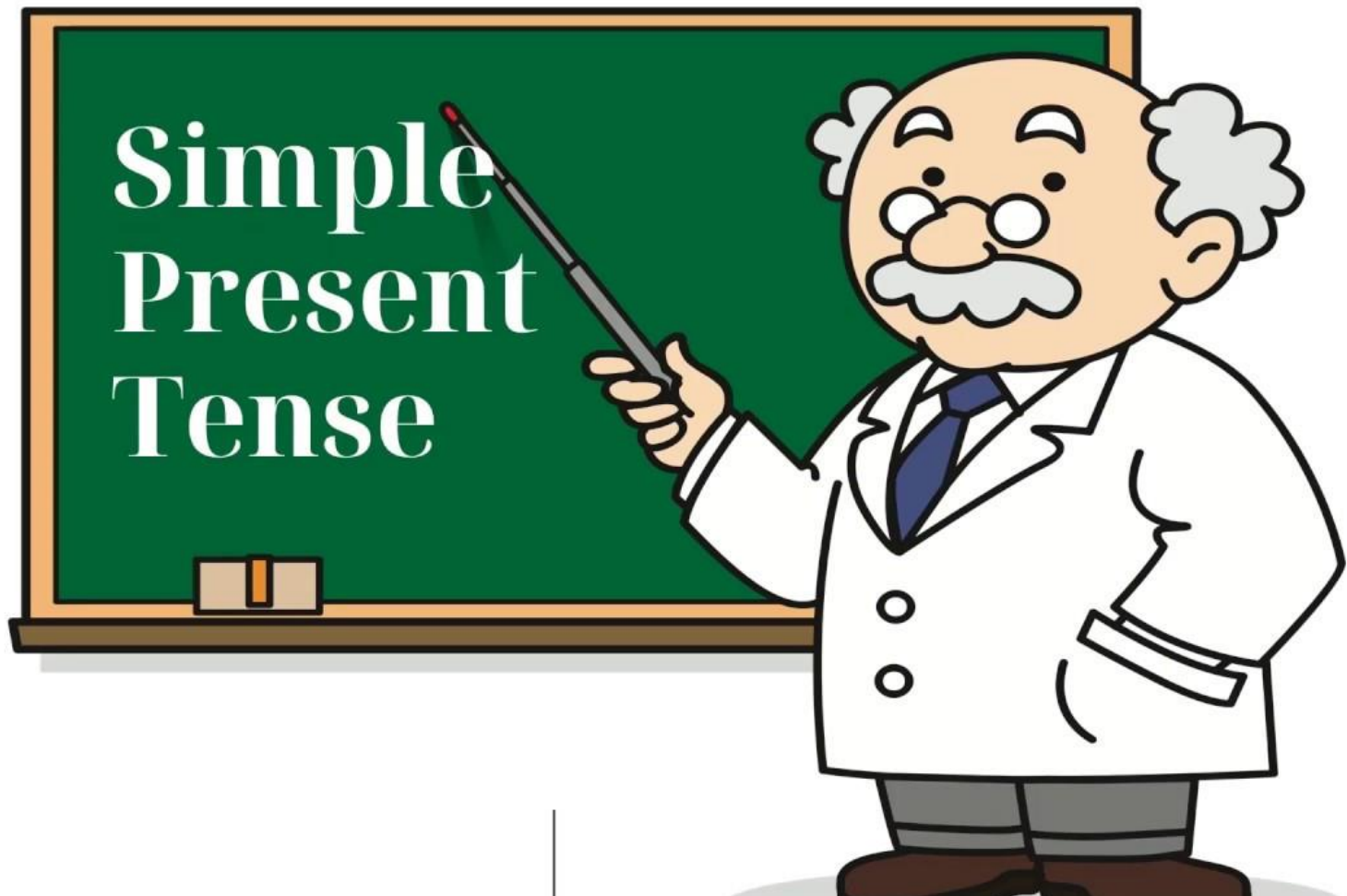
-ING
Form

eating

Past
Participle
Form

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE – SIMPLE



5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

-S
Form

eats

Past
Form

ate

-ING
Form

eating

Past
Participle
Form

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE - SIMPLE
Simple Present Tense

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

-S
Form

eats

ACTIVE VOICE - SIMPLE
Simple Present Tense

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

-S
Form

eats

ACTIVE VOICE

SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE

1. With singular subject, **ONLY -S Form.**

- He **eats** dosa.
- Sita **eats** biriyani.

2. Except singular subjects, **BASE Form.**

I / We / You / They / The children / The girls
eat dosa.

5 VERB FORMS

-S

Form

eats

ACTIVE VOICE

SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE

With **singular** subject, **ONLY -S Form**.

- John **eats** dosa.
- The girl **eats** biriyani.
- The child **eats** idli.
- The king **eats** nuts.
- I have a dog. It **eats** bones.

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

ACTIVE VOICE

SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE

Except singular subjects, **BASE** Form.

I **eat** dosa.

We **eat** dosa.

You **eat** dosa.

They **eat** dosa.

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

ACTIVE VOICE

SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE

Except singular subjects, **BASE** Form.

The children **eat** dosa.

The girls **eat** dosa.

Boban and Molly **eat** dosa.

(Boban and Molly **is** a comic book.)

My friends **eat** dosa.

His parents **eat** dosa.

Simple Present Tense - Test

- Ram – jump
- **Ram jumps.**
- The terrorists – kill innocent people.
- **The terrorists kill innocent people.**
- He – walk to the college.
- **He walks to the college.**
- The bride and bridegroom love each other.
- **The bride and bridegroom love each other.**

SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE



Simple Present Tense

1. Something that is happening now , and which will continue to happen in the future.

- Rajesh **decides** what happens in his company.
- John **works** from home.
- The students **find** it difficult to attend online classes .

Simple Present Tense

2. Things true about your life – where you live, your job, or the kinds of things you like (hobbies).

- Rajesh **lives** in Chennai.
- Sita **works** in a hospital.
- I mostly **read** science fiction.
- Children **like** pudding.
- I **love** cooking.

Simple Present Tense

3. Something which happens again and again; something which happens regularly at a particular time; used with words such as **always, often, sometimes, occasionally, seldom, never** etc.

- I always **think** of my parents.
- The soldiers often **visit** their parents.
- I sometimes **disagree** with my parents.

Simple Present Tense

3. Something which happens regularly at a particular time; used with words such as always, often, sometimes, occasionally, seldom, never etc.

- John occasionally **calls** his parents.
- They seldom **see** their parents.
- Maria never **bothers** about her parents.

Simple Present Tense

4. Something which happens regularly at a particular time; with phrases such as **on Mondays, every day** etc.

- **On Tuesdays Tom goes to St. Jude Church.**
- **My brothers exercise every day.**
- **He comes here on week-ends.**
- **He meditates daily.**
- **He makes cakes during Christmas.**

- Our everyday morning rituals give us strength.
- We have morning rituals every day.

Simple Present Tense

5. Habitual actions

- He **drinks** tea at breakfast.
- She **only eats** fish.
- They **watch** television regularly.
- John **gets** up at 6 o'clock.

Simple Present Tense

5. Habitual actions

- During rainy season we **stay** indoors.
- I **travel** to Bangalore twice a month.
- They **go** to Sabarimala every year.

Simple Present Tense

6. To talk about something which stays the same for ever such as a scientific fact, natural events etc.

- Oil **floats** on water.
- Two and two **make** four.
- Two and two **is** four.

Simple Present Tense

6. To talk about something which stays the same for ever such as a scientific fact, natural events etc.

- The Sun **rises** in the east.
- Water **freezes** at zero degrees.
- The Earth **revolves** around the Sun.
- Kamala's mother **is** Indian.
- The Meenachil (river) **overflows** during heavy rains.

Simple Present Tense

7. To give instructions or directions:

- You go there, ring the bell, and wait.
- Open the packet and pour the contents into hot water.
- You take the bus to Kottayam and get down at Ettumanoor.

Simple Present Tense

8. For fixed arrangements

- His mother **arrives** tomorrow.
- Our holiday **starts** on the 26th March.
- The college **reopens** on 1 December.

Simple Present Tense

9. To express future time, after some conjunctions: *after, when, before, as soon as, until, by the time etc.*

- He will give it to you when you come next Saturday.
- They will call me before they leave.
- I'll wait until the train arrives.

Simple Present Tense

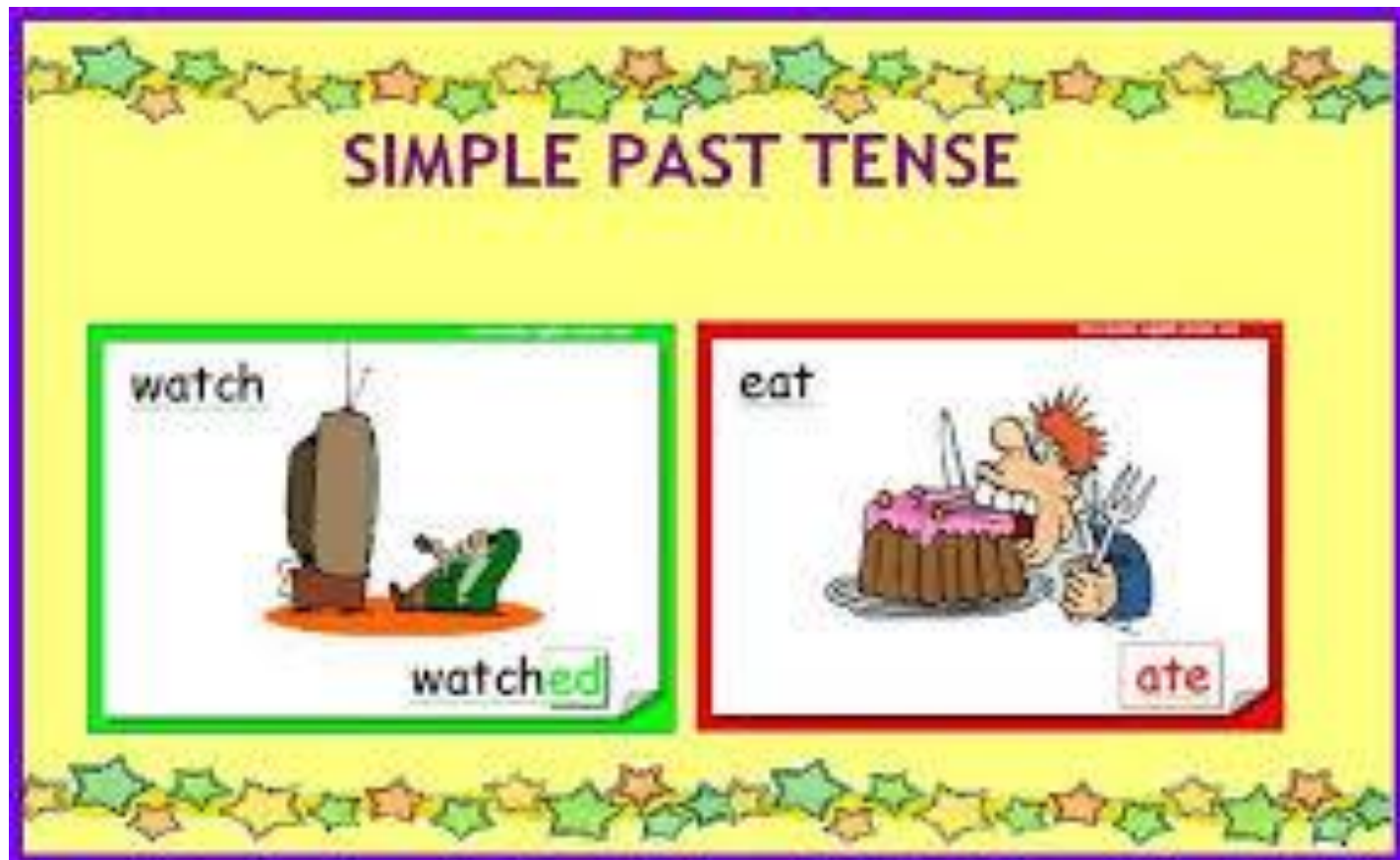
10. To describe what is happening at the exact moment when you are speaking; for example, in sports commentaries.

- Messi **gets** the ball from Ronaldo, **dribbles** and **shoots** – and **scores**!

ACTIVE VOICE – SIMPLE



ACTIVE VOICE – SIMPLE



5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

-S
Form

eats

Past
Form

ate

-ING
Form

eating

Past
Participle
Form

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE - SIMPLE
Simple Past Tense

5 VERB FORMS

Past
Form

ate

ACTIVE VOICE - SIMPLE
Simple Past Tense

5 VERB FORMS

Past
Form

ate

ACTIVE VOICE
SIMPLE PAST TENSE



With all subjects (Singular and Plural), use Past Form.

- John **ate**.
- The children **ate**.
 - I **ate**.
 - We **ate**.

5 VERB FORMS

Past
Form

ate

ACTIVE VOICE
SIMPLE PAST TENSE



With all subjects (Singular and Plural), use Past Form.

- Sita **ate**.
- You **ate**.
- John and Mary **ate**.
- They **ate**.



to walk

I walked

you walked

he walked

they walked

we walked



SIMPLE PAST TENSE



- A. We **spent** our summer holidays in Canada.
- B. We **spend** our summer holidays in Canada.

Did + Spend = Spent

Do + Spend = Spend

Does + Spend = Spends

SIMPLE PAST TENSE

- To talk about an action which happened and finished in the past.
- There is a space between the time when the action happened, and the time when you are speaking or writing about it.

SIMPLE PAST TENSE

- To talk about an action which happened and finished in the past.
 - There is a space between the time when the action happened, and the time when you are speaking or writing about it.
-
- I went home early because I had a headache.
 - The police found a dead body in the river.
 - They went for a walk in the park.

- The police found a dead body in the river.
(Simple Past)
- The police **have** found a dead body in the river. (Present Perfect)
- The policeman **has** found a dead body in the river. (Present Perfect)
- **Yesterday** the police found a dead body in the river. (only Simple Past)
- **Yesterday** the police **have** found a dead body in the river. **X**

SIMPLE PAST TENSE

1. Something that happened **once in the past**:

- *I **met** my wife in 1991.*
- *We **went** to Spain for our holidays.*
- *They **got** home very late last night.*

SIMPLE PAST TENSE

Something that happened **several times in the past:**

- *When I was a boy, I **walked** a mile to school every day.*
- *We **swam** a lot while we were on holiday.*
- *They **always enjoyed** visiting their friends.*

SIMPLE PAST TENSE

Something that was **true for some time in the past:**

- *I **lived** abroad **for** ten years.*
- *He **enjoyed** being a student.*
- *She **played** a lot of tennis when she was younger.*

SIMPLE PAST TENSE

with expressions with ***ago*** :

- ***I met my guru a long time ago.***

SIMPLE PAST TENSE

CUE Words (any specific time in the past)

Eg.

- at midnight
- on Tuesday
- in 1992
- yesterday (*Yesterday the police found...*)
- last year
- two minutes ago
- etc.

Tense?

- He has been questioned yesterday.
- He had been questioned yesterday.

Right or Wrong?

- He has been questioned yesterday. X
- He had been questioned yesterday. X

SIMPLE PAST TENSE

CUE Words (any specific time in the past)

Eg.

- Our visitors **arrived** yesterday.
- Where **did** you **go** last week?
- **Last year** I **went** to London.
- The war **ended** in **1945**.
- I **saw** him **two minutes ago**.
- The shop **closed** at midnight.

SIMPLE PAST TENSE

- To talk about a past state of being.
- Often expressed with the simple past tense of the verb **to be** + an adjective / noun / prepositional phrase.
- They **were** proud of their performance.
- He **was** the leader of the class.
- The teachers **were** on leave.

ACTIVE VOICE – SIMPLE

The simple future tense



Simple Future Tense

I am so sleepy
and tired.



I **will** get you
some coffee..





Simple Future Tense

He **will buy** her
a present.



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Base
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Past
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Form

eating

Past
Participle
Form

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE - SIMPLE
Simple Future Tense

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

ACTIVE VOICE - SIMPLE
Simple Future Tense

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

ACTIVE VOICE
SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE



All Subjects + **will** + base

I **will** eat.

We **will** eat.

You **will** eat.

He **will** eat.

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

ACTIVE VOICE
SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE



All Subjects + **will** + **base**

She **will** eat.

It **will** eat.

They **will** eat.

John **will** eat.

John and Mary **will** eat.

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

ACTIVE VOICE
SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE



All Subjects + will + base

The dog **will** eat.

The children **will** eat.

The teachers **will** eat.

The teacher **will** eat.

The dancers **will** eat.

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Will

1. When we express beliefs about the future:

- *It **will be** a nice day tomorrow.*
- *I think Brazil **will win** the World Cup.*
- *I'm sure you **will enjoy** the film.*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Will

2. To mean *want to* or *be willing to*:

- *I hope you **will come** to my party.*
- *George says he **will help** us.*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Will

3. To make offers and promises:

- *I'll see you tomorrow.*
- *We'll send you an email.*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Will

4. To talk about offers and promises:

- *Tim **will be** at the meeting.*
- *I **will be** there.*
- *Mary **will help** with the cooking.*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Simple Present Tense

For something **scheduled**:

- *We **have** a class next Monday.*
- *His flight **arrives** at 6.30.*
- *The holidays **start** next week.*
- *It's my birthday tomorrow.*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Present Continuous

For plans or arrangements:

- *I am playing football tomorrow.*

Vs

- *I am playing football. (Present Progressive)*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Present Continuous

For plans or arrangements:

- *I am playing football tomorrow.*

Vs

- *I will play football tomorrow.*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Present Continuous

For plans or arrangements:

- *I am playing football tomorrow.*
- *They are coming to see us (tomorrow.)*
- *We're having a party at Christmas.*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

be going to... (verb):

1. To talk about **plans or intentions**:

- *I'm going to drive to work today.*
- *They are going to move to Chennai.*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

be going to:

2. To make **predictions** based on **evidence** we can see:

- *Be careful! **You are going to fall.*** (= I can see that you might fall.)
- *Look at those black clouds. I think **it's going to rain.*** (= I can see that it will rain.)

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Check

- *We **will have** a party at Christmas.*
- *We **are going to have** a party at Christmas.*
- *We're **having** a party at Christmas.*
- *We **have** a party at Christmas.*

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

'Be to' (*Formal Plans or Instructions*)

This structure is formal and is often used in news reports to talk about **official plans**, **instructions**, or **destiny**.

- **Formal Plan:** The President is to visit the disaster zone next month.
- **Instruction/Obligation:** You are to submit your report by the end of the day.

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

'Be about to' (*Immediate Future*)

This form emphasizes that an action is imminent or will happen in the very near future.

Immediate Future:

The show **is about to** start; please take your seats.

I **am about to** send that email.

SIMPLE FUTURE TENSE

Modal Verbs

Modal verbs can express a possibility or necessity regarding the future.

- May/Might/Could: Possibility (less certain than 'will')
- I might go to the concert if I finish my work.
- Should/Ought to: Expectation/High Probability
- The package should arrive by Friday.
- Must/Have to: Future Necessity/Obligation
- We have to leave before dawn tomorrow.
- We(start) our own business after graduation.
(Expresses a pre-planned intention)

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

-S
Form

eats

Past
Form

ate

-ING
Form

eating

Past
Participle
Form

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE –
PROGRESSIVE/CONTINUOUS TENSE

5 VERB FORMS

-ING
Form

eating

ACTIVE VOICE – PROGRESSIVE/CONTINUOUS TENSE

5 VERB FORMS

-ING
Form

ACTIVE VOICE
PROGRESSIVE TENSE

eating

'Be' family member + -ing Form

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

am / is / are + -ing Form

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE (Active)



am / is / are + -ing Form

- I **am** studying.
- He **is** sleeping.
- They **are** praying.
- We **are** exercising.
- You **are** not listening.
- I **am** not going.

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE (Active)



am / is / are + -ing Form

- Sita **is** leaving.
- The children **are** crying.
- The teacher **is** driving.
- The teachers **are** driving.
- The dog **is** barking.
- The toys **are** moving.

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE



PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- To talk about something which is happening NOW at the time you are speaking or writing.
- You often use this meaning with words and phrases that EXPRESS PRESENT TIME, such as **now, at the moment, currently etc.**

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- To talk about something which is happening NOW at the time you are speaking or writing.
- "What's Tom doing (now)?" "He's (he is) watching television".
- It's raining again.
- I'm looking for my glasses.

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

You often use this meaning with words and phrases that EXPRESS PRESENT TIME, such as **now, at the moment, currently etc.**

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

You often use this meaning with words and phrases that EXPRESS PRESENT TIME, such as **now, at the moment, currently etc.**

- *(Now)* He is preparing for his exams.
- *(At the moment)* He is doing nothing.
- *(Currently)* He is teaching in a college.

- He prepares well for his exams.
- He does nothing.
- He teaches in a college.

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- To say that something is happening now, but will only continue for a limited period of time.
- We live in France. (=France is our permanent home)
- We're living in France. (=We are living there for a limited period of time)

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- To say that something is happening now, but will only continue for a limited period of time.
- **He cooks his own meals.** (=He always does it)
- **He is cooking his own meals.** (=He does not usually do it)

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

Repetition and Irritation with “always/ constantly/”

- She **is** always **coming** to class late.
- He **is** constantly **talking**. He annoys everyone.
- I don't like them because they **are** always **complaining**.

BUT

- She always **gets** the first prize

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

We can also use this tense for other kinds of temporary situations, even if the action isn't happening at this moment.

- John's (*John is*) working in a hotel until he finds a job in his field. (He might not be working now.)
- I'm reading a really great book.

PRESENT PROGRESSIVE TENSE

If you want to talk about the subjects you are studying at school, college or university, you usually use the present progressive.

- She's *(She is)* studying AI at SJCET.
NOT She studies AI at SJCET.
- I'm studying English. **NOT** I study English.

BUT

- He studies every day.
- She studies birds.
(research/passion/hobby)

5 VERB FORMS

-ING
Form

ACTIVE VOICE
PROGRESSIVE TENSE

eating

'Be' family member + -ing Form

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

was / were + -ing Form

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE (Active)



was / were + -ing Form

- I **was** studying.
- He **was** sleeping.
- They **were** praying.
- We **were** exercising.
- You **were** not listening.
- I **was** not going.

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE (Active)



was / were + -ing Form

- Sita **was** leaving.
- The children **were** crying.
- The teacher **was** driving.
- The teachers **were** driving.
- The dog **was** barking.
- The toys **were** moving.

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE



PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

To talk about something that happened in the past, *and continued to happen for only a limited period of time.*

- We were living in France (at that time).
- I was trying to get the waiter's attention.
- A man was looking at me in a very strange way. (The man was very tall.)
- (A man looked at me.)

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

You use the past progressive to talk about something which continued to happen for a period of time, during which another thing happened.

- I was watching TV when the phone rang.
- He fell down when the phone rang.
- The phone was ringing when I reached home.
- (When I reached home the phone rang.)
- They met each other while they were staying in London.

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

In the **simple past**, a specific time is used to show when an action began or finished. In the **past continuous**, a specific time only interrupts the action.

- Last night at 6.00, I **had** dinner.
(I started eating at 6.00.)
- Last night at 6.00, I **was having** dinner.
(I started earlier; and at 6.00, I was in the process of eating dinner.)

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

When you use the past continuous with two actions in the same sentence, it expresses the idea that both actions were happening at the same time. The actions are parallel.

- I **was studying** while he **was making** dinner.
- While Ellen **was reading**, Tim **was watching** television.
- **Were you listening** while he **was talking**?

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

When you use the past continuous with two actions in the same sentence, it expresses the idea that both actions were happening at the same time. The actions are parallel.

- I **was studying** **while** he **was making** dinner.
- **While** Ellen **was reading**, Tim **was watching** television.
- **Were you listening** **while** he **was talking**?

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

When you use the past continuous with two actions in the same sentence, it expresses the idea that both actions were happening at the same time. The actions are parallel.

- I **was studying** while he **was making** dinner.
- While Ellen **was reading**, Tim(simple past)

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

When you use the past continuous with two actions in the same sentence, it expresses the idea that both actions were happening at the same time. The actions are parallel.

- While Ellen **was reading**, Tim **shouted**.
- While Tim **was reading**, Ellen **was shouting**.

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

When you use the past continuous with two actions in the same sentence, it expresses the idea that both actions were happening at the same time. The actions are parallel.

- I **was studying** while he **was making** dinner.
- I **was studying** while he **made** dinner.
- While Ellen **was reading**, Tim **left**.
- While Ellen **was reading**, Tim **was leaving**. **X**
- While Tim **was leaving**, Ellen **read** a quotation from the Bible.

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

We often use a series of parallel actions to describe the atmosphere at a particular time in the past.

- When I walked into the office, several people **were** busily **typing**, some **were talking** on the phones, the boss **was yelling** directions, and customers **were waiting** to be helped. One customer **was yelling** at a secretary and **waving** his hands. Others **were complaining** to each other about the bad service.

PAST PROGRESSIVE TENSE

Repetition and Irritation with “always/ constantly/”

- She **was always coming** to class late.
- He **was constantly talking**. He annoyed everyone.
- I didn't like them because they **were always complaining**.

5 VERB FORMS

-ING
Form

ACTIVE VOICE
PROGRESSIVE TENSE

eating

'Be' family member + -ing Form

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

will + be + -ing Form

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

(Active)



will + be + -ing Form

- I will be studying.
- He will be sleeping.
- They will be praying.
- We will be exercising.
- You will not be listening.
- I will not be going.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

(Active)



will + be + -ing Form

- Sita will be leaving.
- The children will be crying.
- The teacher will be driving.
- The teachers will be driving.
- The dog will be barking.
- The toys will be moving.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE



FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

To talk about an action in the future that overlaps another shorter action or a time. The action in the Future Continuous usually starts before and might continue after the second action or time. This is very similar to how we use the past continuous in the past.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- At eight o'clock, I'll be having dinner.
- I'll be waiting when you arrive.

(Future Progressive + Simple Present)

(The tense after 'when' is usually Simple Present)

I'll be waiting when you **will** arrive. **X**

*I was sleeping **when** you came.*

(Past Progressive + Simple Past)

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

We can use the Future Continuous to talk about something that will happen if everything happens as we expect.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- The Government **will be making** a statement later.
- **I'll be seeing** Jim at the conference next week.
- When he is in Australia **he will be staying** with friends.
- When **will you be leaving?**

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

The Difference

- When will you be leaving?
- When will you leave? (It's an order, request...)

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

The Future Continuous can be used to project ourselves into the future.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- This time next week I **will be trekking** in Thekkady.
- Just think, next Monday **you will be working** in your new job.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

The future continuous can be used for predicting or guessing about future events.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- **He'll be coming** to the meeting, I expect.
- I guess **you'll be feeling** thirsty after working in the sun.
- **You'll be missing** the sunshine once you're back in England.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

In the interrogative form, the future continuous can be used to ask politely for information about the future.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- **Will you be bringing** your friend to the party tonight?
- **Will Rajesh be coming** with us?
- **Will she be going** to the party tonight?
- **Will I be sleeping** in this room?

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

When combined with *still*, the future continuous refers to events that are already happening now and that we expect to continue some time into the future.

FUTURE PROGRESSIVE TENSE

- In an hour **I'll still be ironing** my clothes.
- Tomorrow **he'll still be suffering** from his cold.
- **Won't stock prices still be falling** in the morning?
- Unfortunately, **sea levels will still be rising** in 20 years.

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

-S
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eats

Past
Form

ate

-ING
Form

eating

Past
Participle
Form

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE – PERFECT TENSE

5 VERB FORMS

Past
Participle
Form

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE – PERFECT TENSE

5 VERB FORMS

Past
Participle

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE
PERFECT TENSE

have / has / had + Past Participle

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

have / has + Past Participle Form

They have eaten.
The girl has eaten.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE (Active)



have / has + Past Participle Form

- I **have** studied.
- He **has** slept.
- They **have** prayed.
- We **have** exercised.
- You **have** not listened.
- I **have** not gone.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE (Active)



have / has + Past Participle Form

- Sita **has** left.
- The children **have** cried.
- The teacher **has** forgiven.
- The teachers **have** forgiven.
- The dog **has** barked.
- The toys **have** moved.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE



PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

- To talk about something that happened in the past and is finished, **but which still affects the situation now.**
- John resigned.
- **John** has resigned.
- John has **already** resigned.
- **John** has **just** resigned. (**Just** is a cue word; Just = Very recently)
- John ***just*** resigned. (Just = nobody knows why)

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

To say that something started to happen in the past and has continued to happen up to now.

There is a clear difference with the past tense, which you use when the action is finished.

- **Present perfect:** I have lived in Chicago for many years. (=I still live there now/I MAY still be living there)
- **Simple past:** I lived in Chicago for many years. (=Now I live somewhere else)

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

To say that something started to happen in the past and has continued to happen up to now. *There is a clear difference with the past tense, which you use when the action is finished.*

- **Present perfect:** Jim has worked for us since 1992. (=He still works for us now)
- **Simple past:** John worked for us from 1992 to 1996. (=He does not work for us any more)
- **Simple past:** John worked for us for 4 years. (=He does not work for us any more)

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

To say that something started to happen in the past and has continued to happen up to now. *There is a clear difference with the past tense, which you use when the action is finished.*

- **Present perfect:** Jim **has worked** for us since 1992.
 - (He still works for us now)
- **Simple past:** John **worked** for us from 1992 to 1996.
 - (He does not work for us any more)
- **Simple past:** John **worked** for us for 4 years.
 - (He does not work for us any more)
- **Present perfect:** Jim **has worked (has been working)** for us for 4 years.
 - (He still works for us now/ till recently)

- Jim has been working for us from 1992 (to date.)
- Jim works for us.
- Jim is working for us.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

To say that something started to happen in the past and has continued to happen up to now.

There is a clear difference with the past tense, which you use when the action is finished.

- I am living here for 10 years. **X**
- I live here for 10 years. **X**
- I have lived (have been living) here **for** 10 years.
- *I lived here **for** 10 years.*

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

You use the present perfect to talk about something that happened at some time in past before now, but it is not important to say when it happened.

- She has had several jobs abroad.
- There have been problems with this computer in the past.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

You use the present perfect to talk about something that happened at some time in past before now, but it is not important to say when it happened.

- *This meaning of the present perfect is often used in news reports.*
- There has been a big earthquake in Japan, and hundreds of people have been killed.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

You use the present perfect to talk about something that happened at some time in past before now, but it is not important to say when it happened.

- *You can emphasize this meaning by using **ever** in questions, or **never** in negative sentences.*
- Have you **ever** visited Scotland?
- I've **never** been in a plane before.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

If you give the date, year, or time when something happened, you must use the simple past, not the present perfect.

- I spoke to him yesterday.
- *I have spoken to him yesterday.* X
- They arrived in the US last week.
- *They have arrived in the US last week.* X

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

Time Up to Now: since, for

- She has lived here since 2010.
- She has lived here for ten years.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

Unspecified Past: ever, never

- Have you ever visited Paris?
- I have never eaten sushi.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

Recent Past: just, recently, lately

- They have **just** finished their homework.
- He has **recently** shifted to Chennai.
- She has **lately** joined an evening course.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

Until Now/Still Relevant: yet, already, still
(*in negative/interrogative*)

- Has he arrived yet?
- I have already seen that movie.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

Repetitions:

many times, several times, often

- I have called him many times.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

Current Period:

today, this week, this month, so far

- We have had three exams **this week**.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

1. I haven't seen her (a) tomorrow, (b) last week, (c) since Friday.
2. Have you (a) often (b) ever (c) yesterday been to London?
3. The train (a) just left, (b) has just left, (c) is just leaving.
4. We (a) have lived (b) lived (c) live here for ten years.
5. She hasn't finished the report (a) already (b) yet (c) tomorrow.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

6. They (a) went (b) have gone (c) are going to the cinema several times this month.

7. He (a) has already had (b) already had (c) is already having dinner.

8. I (a) never flew (b) have never flown (c) didn't never fly in a helicopter.

9. (a) Last year, (b) Since childhood, (c) Tomorrow, she has loved reading.

10. So far, the students (a) are completing (b) have completed (c) completed four assignments.

PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

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PRESENT PERFECT TENSE - REVISION

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10. So far, the students (a) are completing (b) **have completed** (c) completed four assignments.

5 VERB FORMS

Past
Participle

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE
PERFECT TENSE

have / has / had + Past Participle

PAST PERFECT TENSE

had + Past Participle Form

They **had** eaten.
The girl **had** eaten.

PAST PERFECT TENSE (Active)



had + Past Participle Form

- I **had** studied.
- He **had** slept.
- They **had** prayed.
- We **had** exercised.
- You **had** not listened.
- I **had** not gone.

PAST PERFECT TENSE (Active)



had + Past Participle Form

- Sita **had** left.
- The children **had** cried.
- The teacher **had** forgiven.
- The teachers **had** forgiven.
- The dog **had** barked.
- The toys **had** moved.

PAST PERFECT TENSE



PAST PERFECT TENSE

To talk about a past action which took place before another past action we can use **had**, followed by the **past participle** of the main verb.

- Had left
- Had gone
- Had arrived
- Had written

PAST PERFECT TENSE

We can use the past perfect to show the order of two past events.

The past perfect shows the earlier action and the past simple shows the later action.

- When the police arrived, the thief had escaped.
- *It doesn't matter in which order we present the two events. The following sentence has the same meaning.*
- The thief had escaped when the police arrived.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Note that if there's only a single event, we don't use the past perfect, even if it happened a long time ago.

- The Romans spoke Latin.
- (**NOT** ~~The Romans had spoken Latin.~~)

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Past Perfect after 'before'

- *We can also use before + past perfect to show that an action was not done or was incomplete when the past simple action happened.*
- They left before I'd spoken to them.
- Sadly, the author died before he'd finished the series.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Past Perfect with Adverbs

- We often use the adverbs *already* (= 'before the specified time'), *still* (= as previously), *just* (= 'a very short time before the specified time'), *ever* (= 'at any time before the specified time') or *never* (= 'at no time before the specified time') with the **past perfect**.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Past Perfect with Adverbs

- We often use the adverbs *already* (= 'before the specified time'), *still* (= as previously), *just* (= 'a very short time before the specified time'), *ever* (= 'at any time before the specified time') or *never* (= 'at no time before the specified time') with the ***past perfect***.
- I called his office but he'd **already** left.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Past Perfect with Adverbs

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- It **still** hadn't rained at the beginning of May.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Past Perfect with Adverbs

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- I went to visit her when she'd **just** moved to Berlin.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Past Perfect with Adverbs

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- It was the most beautiful photo I'd **ever** seen.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Past Perfect with Adverbs

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- Had you **ever** visited London when you moved there?

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Past Perfect with Adverbs

- We often use the adverbs *already* (= 'before the specified time'), *still* (= as previously), *just* (= 'a very short time before the specified time'), *ever* (= 'at any time before the specified time') or *never* (= 'at no time before the specified time') with the ***past perfect***.
- Had you **ever** visited London????

PAST PERFECT TENSE

Past Perfect with Adverbs

- We often use the adverbs *already* (= 'before the specified time'), *still* (= as previously), *just* (= 'a very short time before the specified time'), *ever* (= 'at any time before the specified time') or *never* (= 'at no time before the specified time') with the ***past perfect***.
- I'd **never** met anyone from California before I met Jim.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

To talk about a past action which took place before another past action we can use **had**, followed by the **past participle** of the main verb.

- After the visitors **had left**, we **watched** TV.
- *(After the visitors **left**, we **watched** TV.)*
- *(After the visitors **left**, we **also left**.)*
- After the visitors **had left**, we **left**.
- They **told** me that the taxi **had** (already) **arrived**.
- *(already is a cue word – Past/Present Perfect)*

PAST PERFECT TENSE

To talk about a past action which took place before another past action can use had, followed by the past participle of the main verb.

- They **had selected** somebody before the interview **was conducted**.
- The building **had burned / had burnt down** by the time the fire-force **arrived**.
- After they -----(conduct) the interview, they -----(select) a candidate.???

PAST PERFECT TENSE

To talk about a past action which took place before another past action can use **had**, followed by the past participle of the main verb.

- A train **left** when I reached the railway station.
- The train **had left** when I **reached** the railway station.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

To talk about a past action which took place before another past action can use had, followed by the past participle of the main verb.

- First I made / had made the salad, then I boiled the rice.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

To talk about a past action which took place before another past action can use had, followed by the past participle of the main verb.

- First I made ~~/had made~~ the salad, then I boiled the rice.

PAST PERFECT TENSE

The **past perfect** refers to time up to a point in the past (**time up to then**), just as the **present perfect** refers to something that happened in the time up to the moment of speaking (**time up to now**):

PAST PERFECT TENSE

The **past perfect** refers to time up to a point in the past (**time up to then**), just as the **present perfect** refers to something that happened in the time up to the moment of speaking (**time up to now**):

- *I **had visited** five countries in Europe **by** 2001.*
(**Past Perfect**: 'time up to then'-2001).
- *I **have visited** five countries in Europe.*
(**Present Perfect**: 'time up to now').
- *I **visited** five countries in Europe (last year/**in** 2001).* (**Simple Past**: specific time in the past).

PAST PERFECT TENSE

The **past perfect** refers to time up to a point in the past (**time up to then**), just as the **present perfect** refers to something that happened in the time up to the moment of speaking (**time up to now**):

- *I'd been to five countries in Europe by 2001.*
- Past perfect: 'time up to then' (2001).

Different Meanings

- I have been to five countries in Europe.
- I went to five countries in Europe.
- I had been to five countries in Europe.

Different Meanings

- I have been to five countries in Europe.
 - I went to five countries in Europe.(in 2001)
 - I had been to five countries in Europe.
-
- *I **had been** to five countries in Europe by 2001.*
 - *I **had been** to five countries in Europe by the time (before) I **retired**.*
 - *I **had been** to five countries in Europe by the time I **got** tired of travelling..*

USED TO ...

- You use **used to ...** when you want to say that something happened in the past over a period of time, but it no longer happens now.
- It is found only in the past tense.
- **used + to infinitive** form of the main verb
- **used to smoke, used to go, used to be....**

USED TO

- I used to play football *a lot* when I was at school.
- She used to smoke ten cigarettes a day.
- She **smoked** ten cigarettes during the party.
- The club used to be very fashionable.
- They used to live in Chennai.
- My brother used to go abroad *every year*.
- My brother **went** abroad last year.
- My brother **goes** abroad every year.

USED TO / Negatives

- You say **didn't use to**, or **used not to**.
- I didn't use to like spicy food.
- I didn't used **d** to like spicy food. **X**

Or

- I used not to like spicy food.

- Do + Go = Go
- Does + Go = Goes
- Did + Go = Went
- Did + Jump = Jumped
- He jumped.
- He did jump.

USED TO / Questions

- did (subject - you/she/John etc.) use to...?
- Did you use to smoke?
- Did you used to smoke? **X**
- What did she use to call him?

Students' responses

- I didn't used to play....X
- He used to go ~~to~~ outside with his friends.
- He used to go to England during holidays.
- Did you ~~used~~ to go ~~for~~ surfing?
- I didn't ~~used~~ to write diary.
- He didn't ~~used~~ to play video games.
- She didn't use to listen to music.

- He used to go to his house when in Kerala.
- He used to go home before sunset.
- They used to go out for dinner.
- They used to go to Indian Coffee House often.

Be + Used to + Gerund

- Arabs **are used to living** in the desert.
- Be + ing-form
- (They **are living** in the desert.)

BUT

- Malayalees **used to live** in the desert.

- We **used to** get up late.
- Now we **are used to** getting up early.
- I **used to** smoke in the office.
- I **am used to** people smoking in the office.

5 VERB FORMS

Past
Participle

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE
PERFECT TENSE

have / has / had + Past Participle

FUTURE PERFECT TENSE

will + have + Past Participle Form

They will have eaten.

The girl will have eaten.

FUTURE PERFECT TENSE (Active)



will + have + Past Participle Form

- I will have studied...
- He will have slept...
- They will have prayed...
- We will have exercised...
- You will not have passed...
- I will not have gone...

FUTURE PERFECT TENSE (Active)



will + have + Past Participle Form

- Sita **will have** left...
- The children **will have** cried...
- The teacher **will have** forgiven...
- The teachers **will have** forgiven...
- The dog **will have** barked...
- The toys **will have** moved...

FUTURE PERFECT TENSE



FUTURE PERFECT TENSE

The future perfect tense refers to a completed action in the future. When we use this tense **we are projecting ourselves forward into the future and looking back at an action that will be completed some time later than now.** It is most often used with a time expression.

FUTURE PERFECT TENSE

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- **I will have been** here six months **on 23** January, 2026.
- I will have been here six months **by** January, 2026.
- By the time you read this **I will have left.**

FUTURE PERFECT TENSE

It refers to a completed action in the future. When we use this tense **we are projecting ourselves forward into the future and looking back at an action that will be completed some time later than now.** It is most often used with a time expression.

- **You will have finished** your report by this time next week.
- **Won't they have arrived** by 5:00 pm?
- *Will they have arrived by 5.00 pm?*
- *(Won't/Will they arrive by 5.00 pm?)???*
- *Will he ~~has?~~/have arrived by 5.00 pm?*
- **Will you have eaten** when I pick you up?

- She will have fallen asleep by the time we **will** get home. **X**
- She will have fallen asleep by the time we **get** home.
- They will have been played by evening. **X**
- They will have stopped *playing (gerund)* by evening.

5 VERB FORMS

Base
Form

eat

-S
Form

eats

Past
Form

ate

-ING
Form

eating

Past
Participle
Form

eaten

ACTIVE VOICE – PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

Action: How long?

5 VERB FORMS

-ING
Form

eating

ACTIVE VOICE – PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

5 VERB FORMS

-ing
Form

ACTIVE VOICE
PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

eating

have / has / had + been + -ing form

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

have / has + been + -ing form

They **have been** eating....
The girl **has been** eating...

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



have / has + been + -ing form

- I have been studying.....
- He has been sleeping.....
- They have been praying.....
- We have been exercising.....
- You have not been listening.....
- I have not been going.....

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

have / has + been + -ing form

- The children have been crying.....
- The teacher has been teaching.....
- The teachers have been teaching...
- The dog has been barking.....
- The toys have been moving.....

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



have / has + been + -ing form

1. Actions starting in the past and continuing now:

To emphasise how long an activity has been happening.

- *“He **has been teaching** grammar for twenty years.”*
- **Explanation:** He started twenty years ago and is still teaching now.

PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



have / has + been + -ing form

2. Actions that recently stopped with a visible result:

The focus is on the activity itself rather than the finished product.

*“I am tired because **I have been working** in the garden.”*

Explanation: The work may have just finished, but the physical state (tiredness) is a result of the continuous activity.

5 VERB FORMS

-ing
Form

ACTIVE VOICE
PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

eating

have / has / had + been + -ing form

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

had + been + -ing form

They had been eating....
The girl had been eating...

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



had + been + -ing form

- I had been studying.....
- He had been sleeping.....
- They had been praying.....
- We had been exercising.....
- You had not been listening.....
- I had not been going.....

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

had + been + -ing form

- The children had been crying.....
- The teacher had been teaching.....
- The teachers had been teaching...
- The dog had been barking.....
- The toys had been moving.....

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



had + been + -ing form

1. Duration before a past event:

To show that an action was ongoing up until another action in the past occurred.

Example:

“The students had been studying for three hours when the power went out.”

Explanation:

The continuous act of studying was interrupted by the sudden event (power outage).

PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

had + been + -ing form

2. Cause of a past result:

To explain why something was the case at a specific moment in the past.

Example:

“She failed the exam because she had not been attending classes regularly.”

Explanation:

The past ongoing lack of attendance led to the result of failing.

5 VERB FORMS

-ing
Form

ACTIVE VOICE
PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

eating

have / has / had + been + -ing form

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

will have + been + -ing form

They will have been eating....

The girl will have been eating...

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



will have + been + -ing form

- I will have been writing.....
- He will have been sleeping.....
- They will have been preparing.....
- We will have been exercising.....
- You will have been teaching.....
- I will have been waiting.....

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE

will have + been + -ing form

- The children will have been building.....
- The teacher will have been teaching.....
- The teachers will have been teaching...
- The dog will have been barking.....
- The toys will have been moving.....

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



will have + been + -ing form

When to use it?

Duration up to a future point:

To project ourselves forward in time and look back at the duration of an activity. It is almost always used with a time expression starting with "by" or "for."

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



will have + been + -ing form

When to use it? **Duration up to a future point:**

To project ourselves forward in time and look back at the duration of an activity. It is almost always used with a time expression starting with "**by**" or "**for**."

Example: "By next December, I **will have been living** in this city **for** a decade."

Explanation: We are looking ahead to December and measuring the total duration of the stay up to that point.

FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS TENSE



will have + been + -ing form

When to use it? **Duration up to a future point:**

To project ourselves forward in time and look back at the duration of an activity. It is almost always used with a time expression starting with "**by**" or "**for**."

Example: "By the time the exam starts, they **will have been revising for** ten hours straight."

Explanation: This emphasises the exhaustion or effort that will have accumulated by a specific future deadline.

Creating a Semi-Auxiliary

- Go = Do + Go
- Goes = Does + Go
- Went = Did + Go